

SUMMARY OF TENSES- FORM, USE AND SIGNAL WORDS

Source: <https://www.ego4u.com/en/cram-up/grammar/tenses>

tense	Affirmative/Negative/Question	Use	Signal Words
<u>Simple Present</u>	A: He speaks. N: He does not speak. Q: Does he speak?	- action in the present taking place regularly, never or several times - facts - actions taking place one after another - action set by a timetable or schedule	always, every ..., never, normally, often, seldom, sometimes, usually if sentences type I (<i>If I talk, ...</i>)
<u>Present Progressive</u>	A: He is speaking. N: He is not speaking. Q: Is he speaking?	action taking place in the moment of speaking - action taking place only for a limited period of time - action arranged for the future	at the moment, just, just now, Listen!, Look!, now, right now
<u>Simple Past</u>	A: He spoke. N: He did not speak. Q: Did he speak?	- action in the past taking place once, never or several times - actions taking place one after another - action taking place in the middle of another action	yesterday, 2 minutes ago, in 1990, the other day, last Friday if sentence type II (<i>If I talked, ...</i>)
<u>Past Progressive</u>	A: He was speaking. N: He was not speaking. Q: Was he speaking?	- action going on at a certain time in the past - actions taking place at the same time - action in the past that is interrupted by another action	while, as long as

<u>Present Perfect Simple</u>	A: He has spoken. N: He has not spoken. Q: Has he spoken?	■ putting emphasis on the result ■ action that is still going on ■ action that stopped recently ■ finished action that has an influence on the present ■ action that has taken place once, never or several times before the moment of speaking	already, ever, just, never, not yet, so far, till now, up to now
<u>Present Perfect Progressive</u>	A: He has been speaking. N: He has not been speaking. Q: Has he been speaking?	■ putting emphasis on the course or duration (not the result) ■ action that recently stopped or is still going on ■ finished action that influenced the present	all day, for 4 years, since 1993, how long?, the whole week
<u>Past Perfect Simple</u>	A: He had spoken. N: He had not spoken. Q: Had he spoken?	■ action taking place before a certain time in the past ■ sometimes interchangeable with past perfect progressive ■ putting emphasis only on the fact (not the duration)	already, just, never, not yet, once, until that day if sentence type III (<i>If I had talked, ...</i>)
<u>Past Perfect Progressive</u>	A: He had been speaking. N: He had not been speaking. Q: Had he been speaking?	■ action taking place before a certain time in the past ■ sometimes interchangeable with past perfect simple ■ putting emphasis on the duration or course of an action	for, since, the whole day, all day
<u>Future I Simple</u>	A: He will speak. N: He will not speak. Q: Will he speak?	■ action in the future that cannot be influenced ■ spontaneous decision ■ assumption with regard to the future	in a year, next ..., tomorrow If-Satz Typ I (<i>If you ask her, she will help you.</i>) <i>assumption:</i> I think, probably, perhaps

<u>Future I Progressive</u>	A: He will be speaking. N: He will not be speaking. Q: Will he be speaking?	▪ action that is going on at a certain time in the future ▪ action that is sure to happen in the near future	in one year, next week, tomorrow
<u>Future II Simple</u>	A: He will have spoken. N: He will not have spoken. Q: Will he have spoken?	▪ action that will be finished at a certain time in the future	by Monday, in a week
<u>Future II Progressive</u>	A: He will have been speaking. N: He will not have been speaking. Q: Will he have been speaking?	▪ action taking place before a certain time in the future ▪ putting emphasis on the course of an action	for ..., the last couple of hours, all day long
<u>Conditional I Simple</u>	A: He would speak. N: He would not speak. Q: Would he speak?	▪ action that might take place	if sentences type II (<i>If I were you, I would go home.</i>)
<u>Conditional I Progressive</u>	A: He would be speaking. N: He would not be speaking. Q: Would he be speaking?	▪ action that might take place ▪ putting emphasis on the course / duration of the action	
<u>Conditional II Simple</u>	A: He would have spoken. N: He would not have spoken. Q: Would he have spoken?	▪ action that might have taken place in the past	if sentences type III (<i>If I had seen that, I would have helped.</i>)
<u>Conditional II Progressive</u>	A: He would have been speaking. N: He would not have been speaking. Q: Would he have been speaking?	▪ action that might have taken place in the past ▪ puts emphasis on the course / duration of the action	